

Τηλεκλείδης ὁ Κωμικός

Telecleides Comicus and the Golden Age of Plenty

eul_aid: edi

Period: Κλασική [Classical](#)
Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic \(com, frg\)](#)
Domain: Κωμωδία [Comedy](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Telecleides was an Athenian comic playwright active in the 5th century BCE during the period of Old Comedy. A contemporary and rival of more famous figures like Aristophanes, he won first prize at the City Dionysia three times, with his first victory recorded in 446 BCE. His plays, typical of Old Comedy, featured political satire, social commentary, and fantastical plots performed for Athenian civic festivals.

No complete comedy by Telecleides survives; his work is known only through fragments preserved by later authors. Known titles include **Amphictyons**, **Hesiods**, **Apseudeis**, **Sterrhoi**, and **Priapus**. Modern scholars regard Telecleides as a significant source for understanding the development of Athenian comedy alongside its major figures. His fragments offer valuable glimpses into the genre's style and concerns.

One famous fragment from **Amphictyons** describes a mythical Golden Age of automatic abundance, a theme often interpreted as nostalgic satire on contemporary Athenian life. Other fragments reveal that he satirized contemporary intellectual figures, such as the sophist Protagoras. While the loss of his complete works limits a full assessment, his recorded successes confirm that Telecleides was a respected and influential playwright in his own time.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [Golden Age of Plenty](#) · 85 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · [Golden Age of Plenty](#) · 59 passages